

Brand Name Justification
United States Department of Agriculture
Cloudera

1. Identification of the agency and the contracting activity.

United States Department of Agriculture, Departmental Administration, Office of Contracting and Procurement, Procurement Operations Division, 301 S. Howes Street, Suite 321, Fort Collins, CO 80521.

2. The nature and/or description of the action being approved.

The USDA proposes to issue a brand name task order on a firm-fixed-price basis for software subscription. This order will be as a result of a brand name RFQ issued via STRATUS Pool 3.

3. A description of the supplies or services required to meet the agency's needs (including estimated value).

This requirement is for the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), OCIO Enterprise Data Management Center (EDMC).

Cloudera software-as-a-service (SaaS) subscription
5/01/2025 – 4/30/2026

4. Identification of the exception to fair opportunity and supporting rationale.

Brand Name; FAR 13.501(a) in accordance with 41 U.S.C.1901.

This requirement is for a subscription to Cloudera software as a service (SaaS). Cloudera is the sole manufacturer and source of such subscription offerings. This purchase is critical for EDMC EDAPT's continued operations and functionality in the AgCloud target environment. This acquisition provides licenses and maintenance support from Cloudera to host EDAPT's data lake and data management.

Cloudera data platform (CDP) and its data lake component offer an integrated solution for managing and analyzing vast amounts of data across hybrid and multi-cloud environments. Their unique capabilities are essential for EDMC's data-driven initiatives and operational efficiency. CDP provides a unified platform that combines data warehousing, machine learning, and analytics, enabling seamless data integration and governance. The data lake component allows for scalable storage and processing of structured and unstructured data, facilitating advanced analytics and informed decision-making. This comprehensive approach ensures data consistency, security, and compliance with regulatory standards, which are critical for EDMC operations.

EDMC EDAPT has expended a significant amount of time, effort and money in Cloudera in the AIP environment and the technical feasibility of leveraging other vendors once the platform is migrated to AgCloud is not viable. Alternative solutions lack the comprehensive functionality and seamless integration that CDP and its data lake offer. Implementing multiple disparate tools would introduce complexity, data silos, and potential security vulnerabilities, undermining operational effectiveness. Similar products cannot be modified to meet the agency's needs. Alternative solutions would require significant investment of resources for additional personnel, infrastructure, and

applications to reconstruct existing capabilities. Therefore, procuring Cloudera as a brand-name specific solution is essential to meet USDA EDMC requirements.

5. A determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable due to the expected competition in response to the RFQ. The Government expects 2 or more responses to the RFQ.

6. Any other facts to support the justification.

N/A

7. A statement of actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition if subsequent acquisitions are anticipated.

The brand name justification allows for competition among multiple resellers. Future competitions may also define salient characteristics, if possible, to allow for a brand name or equal competition.